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ADVISORY ON SETTING UP STATE PMU FOR DIGITAL CROP SURVEY

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The Digital Crop Survey is a very useful initiative, yet it is an equally challenging work. The challenge comes from the fact that a crop survey of crores of plots has to be undertaken in justnabout 45 days. Crop survey involves simultaneous operations in all the villages of the State. Some States may have as high as 1 lakh villages, whereas some other States may have 20,000 villages. If it is presumed that there would be 1 crop surveyor for every village, then an equal number of crop surveyors would be required for simultaneous operations. If the crop surveyors are from the government departments only, then it may always involve officials from various departments like Revenue, Panchayati Raj, Agriculture, Horticulture, Sericulture and even Animal Husbandry. If a crop survey is to be done by local youth of the village, even then all these officials would be required as supervisors. Therefore, crop survey also involves a lot of inter-departmental collaboration.

While carrying out digital crop survey, a large number of administrative issues would arise from time to time. For example, some departments may not support in the manner they are expected to support. Some departments may face genuine problems. All these issues of coordination needs to be handled by the Project Monitoring Unit (PMU). The role and responsibilities of the PMU would be as follows:

1. Day to day responsibility and supervision of the progress of digital crop survey at the state level.
2. Discuss issues coming from field on the digital crop survey software and take it up with the software development team.
3. To examine the quality of data coming in the digital crop survey system on a daily basis and to take immediate corrective measures in case of issues.
4. Regular interactions with the field level officials of various departments on the issues they are facing and the progress which is being achieved.
5. Continuous discussion and interaction with the crop surveyors and to encourage them and to resolve their issues. Such interaction can be augmented by way of

group audio call through various software using which more than 1,000 people can be connected simultaneously.

6. To organize meetings of the State Level Committee and to prepare agenda for the same.
7. To brief the Chief Secretary, Development commissioner and the Agriculture Minister from time to time on the progress and the intervention required from their side.
8. To monitor the working of the Help Desk
9. To examine whether the honorarium is being paid in time to the crop surveyors as per the government guidelines.

For all the responsibilities to be discharged, a Project Monitoring Unit would have to be set up under the administrative control of the department which is responsible for the digital crop survey. The PMU would have the following resources:

Proposed structure of Crop Survey Project State PMU

SL. No.	Name of the Post/ Role/ Designation in the PMI-J	Number of Posts	Remarks	
1.	**Project Head**	1	Deputation	In the cadre of Joint Director if filled by line department, graduation in any degree with good knowledge of computer. Of the rank of ADM if the project head is from the revenue department. The project head would invariably be from the department responsible for the conduct of DCS.
2.	**Officer from Revenue Department in the rank of Tahsildar**	1	Deputation	In the cadre of Tahsildar, graduation in any degree with good knowledge of computers preferably agriculture/

3.	**Deputy Director Economics Statistical Department**	1	Deputation	In the cadre of Deputy Director Economics Statistics to be filled by Statistical Department, graduation in any degree with good knowledge of computer and also preferably agriculture/horticulture
4.	**Deputy Director Agriculture**	2	Deputation	in the cadre of DD to be filled by Agriculture Department, graduation in any degree with good knowledge of computer
5.	**Deputy Director Horticulture**	2	Deputation	in the cadre of DD to be filled by Horticulture Department, graduation in any degree with good knowledge of computer.
6.	**Sericulture Officer**	1	Deputation	in the cadre of SEO if filled by Sericulture Department on deputation/ graduation in any degree with good knowledge of computer preferably Sericulture if outsourced for such vacant period.
7.	**Domain Experts/ Subject matter Specialists**	2	Retired Officers/ outsourced	Retired officers with ample experience about the subject.
8.	**IT Technical Consultant**	1	Outsourced	IT Professionals.
9.	**Administrative and Supporting Staff**	2	Outsourced	Typist and Supporting Staff.

It may be noted that the role of the PMU is entirely different from the Help desk. The **PMU is a in-house body of the government department which would drive the project on a day to day basis** including internal departmental coordination and review of progress. On the other side, the **Help Desk is a technical organisation which is supposed to provide technical support for**

field operations to the crop survey on the day to day basis and would primarily be an outsourced body. In fact PMU would control and supervise help desk operations.

It may be noted that as per the guidelines of the crop survey, both the PMU and the Help Desk can be funded out of the funds provided for the project.